

Updated Google Docs

The newer version of Google Docs will support 12 additional formats including Excel, Powerpoint and Adobe Photoshop

Controversial trailer

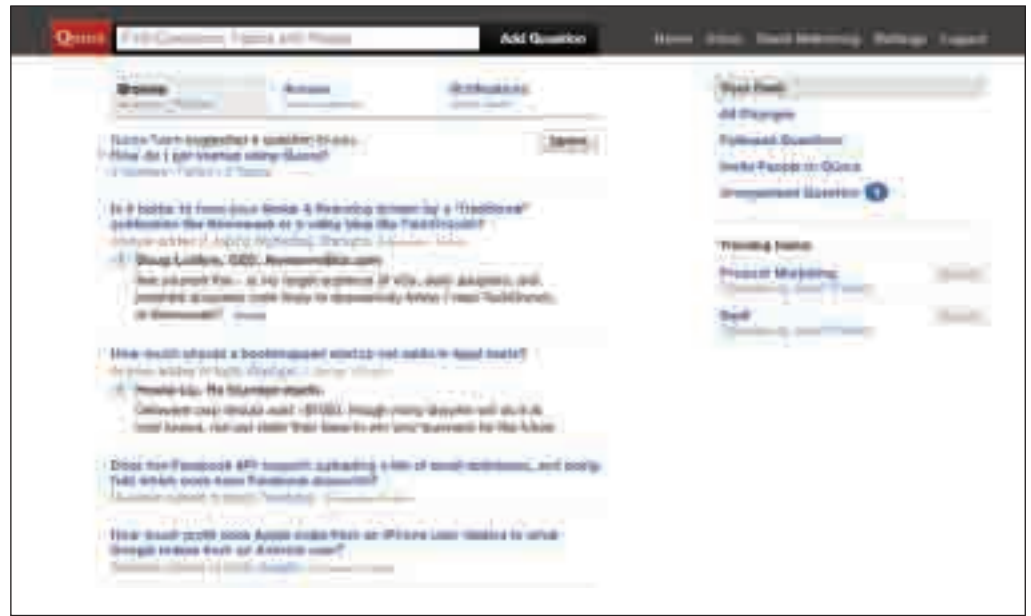
The new zombie apocalypse game Dead Island has caused a lot of stir on the internet mainly because of its disturbing trailer



What is Quora? Why's it gaining so much buzz?

What's the buzz about? The idea of sharing knowledge is certainly not new, and ever since the internet became less of a rarity, and started becoming a mundane connectivity at home and the workplace, this knowledge sharing increased dramatically, whether in the form of static content, or dynamic interactions.

An example of the latter are question and answer based web sites – nothing new as well; which originated from such esoteric roots as Forum 2000 in the late 90s, and ran wild over the course of the last decade with community driven sites such as Yahoo! Answers, Wiki Answers, AnswerBag, and Stack Overflow – some of the longest-running examples out there today. In essence, such web sites follow the crowdsourcing model. As defined by Wikipedia (a crowd-sourced web site itself), crowdsourcing is a neologistic compound of Crowd and Outsourcing for the



act of taking tasks traditionally performed by an employee or contractor, and outsourcing them to a group of people or community, through an "open call" to a large group of people (a crowd) asking for contributions.

Traditionally, with Q&A sites, a problem is posted by an individual or a company, and, the 'best answer' from the community members is selected. Various web sites – usually

of the technical or academic kind (such as Innocentive and Experts-Exchange) – offer a model where the individual that gives the best answer gets a monetary reward from the institution or individual who asked the question. There are many other knowledge-exchange models, some using virtual currency as the means of incentive, others using reputation systems, and some where the site pays researchers to answer questions – instead of the questioner.

These Q&A sites are also known as internet-based knowledge exchange marketplaces, of which there are two types – fee-based (whether for the answerer or questioner) or free. Most of the best known Q&A sites, such as Yahoo! Answers, Ask.com (formerly Ask Jeeves), and WikiAnswers fall in the latter category.

However, most free Q&A sites, especially the most pop-

ular, unfortunately suffer from a number of inherent drawbacks, such as repeated questions and answers, the posting of questions that can be easily answered by simple web queries, as well as the varying quality of answers that come from everyone from trolls to amateurs to experts.

Newer Q&A start-ups are quick to point out these problems, and are trying to incorporate innovative strategies to avoid them. While the first problem, repetition, is easily solvable by a thorough Q&A database check before accepting new questions, or by aggregating similar or identical questions, the second problem – the posting of questions that have readily available and factual answers – is a much harder challenge, one that ironically points to the separation of a mainstream audience from experts. The biggest challenge for free Q&A sites as always,



Quora-Co-Founders (Adam D'Angelo left, Charlie Cheever, right)